MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

QA Automation Engineer | CI/CD and Test Infrastructure

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation engineer with experience owning CI/CD pipelines and test infrastructure for three product teams. Built Kubernetes-based ephemeral environments, reduced pipeline times and developed monitoring for test reliability. Personal infrastructure projects include Terraform provisioning, GitOps and observability. Seeking a DevOps or platform engineering role.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

CI/CD and infrastructure: Professional: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose, Helm, Kubernetes (namespace-level access)

Infrastructure as code and GitOps: Personal projects: Terraform, Argo CD, Ansible (basic)

Cloud and virtual machines: Personal learning and projects: Hetzner VPS; AWS EC2 and S3 basics

Monitoring: Professional: Grafana; personal projects: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki

Languages and data: Python, Bash, SQL, Java (test code), PostgreSQL

Other: Linux, Git, pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

QA Automation Engineer, Test Infrastructure | Odrava Health Software | 2021–Present

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams of approximately 25 developers, covering builds, unit, integration and end-to-end tests, and artifact publishing.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes through parallel test jobs, dependency caching and changes to end-to-end testing; monthly CI runner costs fell by approximately 30%.
- Built merge-request environments, initially with Docker Compose and later with Helm on a shared Kubernetes cluster. Environments include the application, PostgreSQL and seeded data, and are automatically destroyed after merge or 48 hours of inactivity. QA and product teams use them to review features before merge, with end-to-end tests running against each environment.
- Write Helm charts and work with namespace-level access; the platform team operates the shared Kubernetes cluster.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright end-to-end suite of approximately 900 tests. Built Grafana dashboards from CI results to identify flaky tests; the flaky rate fell from 7% to below 1% as teams fixed the top offenders.
- Wrote Bash and Python tools for PostgreSQL test-data seeding and internal CI documentation used in onboarding.
- Wrote the internal “how our CI works” documentation used for onboarding, helping developers and QA engineers understand pipeline workflows and responsibilities.
- Mentored two QA interns in 2023.

QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House | 2019–2021

- Tested web and mobile applications for client projects, using manual and automated methods.
- Introduced a Java and Selenium regression suite for the largest client project and configured Jenkins for nightly runs. Previously, a full manual regression took two people three days.
- Rewrote a small portion of API tests in Python as practice.

Customer Support Specialist, 2nd Line | Brightmill Software House | 2018–2019

- Investigated customer issues using logs and databases and reproduced bugs for developers.

PERSONAL PROJECT

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | 2024–2025

- Built a three-node Raspberry Pi 5 k3s cluster with applications deployed from Git using Argo CD.
- Used Prometheus, Grafana and Loki for monitoring, Traefik for ingress and cert-manager for TLS.
- Provisioned infrastructure for a personal Hetzner VPS with Terraform.

EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATIONS

BEng Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology | 2018

ISTQB Foundation Level | 2019

Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) — In progress; exam scheduled for January 2027 (not yet certified)

LANGUAGES

Polish: Native | English: C1 | German: A2